

The Tantra Called the Wrathful King, the Secret of All Secret Mantras

Krodharāja Sarvamantra Guhyatantra · Toh 433 · Derge Kangyur

ཁ་བློའི་རིག་པ་ཐོས་མཁས་ཅན་གསལ་སྒྲུལ་གསལ་བའི་རིག་པ་

Toh 433 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in English as "The Wrathful King, the Secret of All Secret Mantras," corresponding to the Sanskrit Krodharāja Sarvamantra Guhyatantra and the Tibetan Khro bo'i rgyal po thams cad gsang sngags gsang ba'i rgyud. It belongs to the class of tantric scriptures in the Kangyur and centers on the wrathful deity Acala — the Immovable Protector — presenting teachings on mantra, mudrā, and meditative absorption associated with this powerful protective figure. The text opens with a verse narrative in which the Great Vajradhara, moved by compassion for beings of the three realms afflicted by aversion, pays homage in a blazing charnel ground and entreats the wrathful king to teach, establishing the devotional and soteriological framing characteristic of this class of tantra.

In the language of India: Krodharāja Sarvamantra Guhyatantra nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Tantra Called the Wrathful King, the Secret of All Secret Mantras.

Homage to the Wrathful One, the Immovable Protector.

Now what is to be truly taught:

Beholding the three realms filled with aversion,
in order that all aversion be exhausted,
the Blessed One, whose very nature is compassion,
fashioned the Wrathful Immovable Protector.

The lord whose essential nature is pure,
with mantra, mudrā, and meditative absorption,
with pure dhyāna and enlightened activity —
the Blessed One, the Great Vajradhara,
in the blazing, tumultuous charnel ground,
holding fast, he bowed and earnestly entreated:

"O listen! True great wrathful chief!

For the sake of abiding in all-encompassing purity,
from the secret tantra of the Protector Immovable,
the meditative absorption of the great bodhisattva —

the wondrous liberation — please surely reveal it!"

Then the truly primordial one spoke:

"The hero who dwells in the charnel ground is excellent.
The six mudrās, certainly adorned with bone ornaments,
the one who is the master of the assembled retinue there,
abides in the four causes and the four immeasurables:
this is the conceptual thought of gnosis-thought.

By the unbroken supreme one,
upon the seat of wisdom and skillful means — sun and moon —
he abides in the essential nature of body, speech, and mind,
bearing the marks of the transformed five wisdoms.
Blessed with the beauty of the six mudrās,
he embraces the lady of the charnel ground.

Abiding in the aggregates and so forth as a sage,
lotus and vajra are bestowed with blessing.
Without defensive preparation,
free from signs, unconditioned,
beyond conceptuality, action-free —
the body in the manner of dark gathered poisons.
With vajra noose, threatening, he stands.
The left leg extended, eyes reddish-veined,
in the manner of wisdom — lotus and curved blade.
Embraced on the left, satisfying, ornament-free,
skillful means and wisdom, free from attachment,
the final blessing pressed down, he abides
in the center of the blazing maṇḍala.

Upon Hūṃ stands the cross-marked vajra.
From E, the Dharmadhātu vessel is accomplished — the female.
With weapons, spears, nets.
Resting upon the five deity mudrās of support.
Devotion is what is fully accomplished."

This concludes the first chapter: the chapter on the purity of devotion.

Now what is to be truly taught:

The secret of non-dual transformation:
the wheel of the Immovable, great gnosis.
At the throat, a garland — source of jewels.
Ear ornaments of form — Amitābha.
Bone ear ornaments — Amoghasiddhi.
Ashes the radiant — perfectly pure.

At the eyes, the Vajrā of Desire.
At the ears, she is called the Lady of Aversion.
The nose abandoned entirely the manner of envy.
At the tongue, the Vajrā of Jealousy.
At the body, Vajra Delusion.
At the mind, the Sovereign of Dharma.

The maṇḍala that is the very body, perfectly pure:
the channels are by nature the bindu-drops.
The eight pillars are the eight legs.
The five nectars and the five hues,
right, left, above, below — these are the gates.
Teeth, nails, body hair — tva ra ṇa.
The very hub at the center of the heart.
The queens of the five aggregates,
known as the goddesses of the elements and sense bases.
The four elements are the four gatekeepers.
A fathom in span, four-cornered, the seat —
this is the definitive teaching on the Immovable Protector.

This concludes the second chapter: the chapter on the purity of the body.

Oṃ āryā acala mārya raya krodha hūṃ phaṭ. This is the heart mantra.

Oṃ āryā acala krodha bibhata sa hūṃ phaṭ. This is the near-heart mantra.

Oṃ caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa hūṃ phaṭ. This is the secret heart mantra.

Oṃ ha — nama hi — svāhā hu — bhausaṭ he — hūṃ hūṃ ho — phaṭ haṃ. This is the consecration of ornaments.

Oṃ padma bolarga miyaṃ — ṭaṃ haṃ maṃ byāṃ — vajra pratika kola hūṃ phaṭ. This is the consecration of the mudrā of wisdom and skillful means.

Ka samāra kha na hi māra kha ni samāraya phaṭ. This is for slaying.

Sarva amargaṃ me a hūṃ. This is for common accomplishment.

A gaccha phaṭ. This is for banishing.

Svāhā ratnana. This is for expanding.

Dharmāguta hūṃ. This is for empowerment.

Karma puta śāntaṃ kuru hūṃ. This is for pacifying.

This is from the Chapter Three of the Tantra Called the Secret Tantra of the Mantras of All Wrathful Kings, the Chapter on the Purification of the Mantras of the Noble Immovable One.

Then what is to be explained correctly:

From the union of Father and Mother as nondual,
the hosts of wrathful ones are emanated,
and the chief lady fills the limbs of skillful means.

In the right hand, the Slayer of Yama;
in the left, She Who Cannot Be Overpowered —
these are to be contemplated at Hayagrīva's mouth.

Around the vajra, nectar coils.

At the right shoulder stands Immovable One;

at the left, the King of Desire.

At the right knee, contemplate
the great blazing blue staff.

At the left knee, the Greatly Powerful One.

At the crown, the Wheel-Turning Cakravartin.

The King Nandakeśvarī is to be contemplated
and placed at the two feet.

Again, from the union of Father and Mother,
from the gathering and dispersing clouds of bodhicitta,
the HŪṂ hosts are emanated as wrathful females,
and the chief lady fills the limbs of wisdom.

In the right hand, Vajra Vetālī;
in the left, She Who Cannot Be Overpowered;
at her mouth, the Frowning One;
at her secret place, the Single-Braided One.

Further, at the right shoulder stands

Vajradhātṛīśvarī, Mother of Tathāgatas;

and at the left, the mudrās of the various precious ones are to be meditated upon.

At the right knee stands
the Tathāgata Variegated Lotus;
at the left, from variegated karma,
stands Vajraghaṇṭā of the sky, at the crown.
At the two feet, the goddess
who holds the earth is to be placed.

Through the union of skillful means and wisdom,
from the gathering and dispersing clouds of bodhicitta,
the primordially accomplished buddha families
are drawn forth and arranged as a maṇḍala upon the body.
From their mutual union,
with the great sound of passionate longing,
the hosts of Sugatas are to be invoked
and led into them again and again.

Oṃ sarva tathāgata anuragaṇa vajra svabhāva ātmako'ham.

Like the disk of the moon reflected in water,
clear, of the nature of a deity,
all with three faces and six arms,
magnificent wrathful ones with dance and gesture —
or else with one face and two arms,
the yogin steadfastly meditates.
The supreme and excellent accomplishment will be obtained.
Therefore one should cultivate diligence.

This is Chapter Four from the Ritual Arrangement of the Bodily Maṇḍala from
the Ritual Procedure of the Noble Immovable One.

Then, in the outer maṇḍala,
the emanation of the wrathful ones of the families —
arising from the union of skillful means and wisdom —
is to be explained as the display of magical creation.

Born from the seed of one's own mantra,
the Lord Immovable of Delusion:
his faces are black, white, and red,
encircled by blazing multitudes.
He holds a staff, a wheel, and a vajra,
borne in the right hands.

At his heart he holds a threatening finger and a lasso,
and in the left hands a bell, enemy skull-staff,
together with retinues of sense faculties and the like,
frightening the unbearable obstructors.
Pressing down upon a lotus and the sun,
he abides in the eastern direction,
adorned with the crown ornament of Vairocana.

Born from the seed of one's own mantra,
the Lord Immovable of Miserliness:
bearing the crown of Ratnasambhava,
golden in color, with three faces and six arms,
three eyes, broad chest, adorned with jewels;
faces of yellow, black, and red,
gnashing and baring his fangs, moving about.
Encircled by blazing multitudes,
he holds a vajra club and a sword
in the right hands.

At his heart a threatening finger and a lasso,
and in the left hands a bell and enemy skull-staff.
Abiding in the posture of extending the left leg,
he frightens the unbearable obstructors.
Pressing down upon a lotus and the sun,
he abides in the southern direction.

Born from the seed-syllable of one's own mantra,
the Lord Immovable of Attachment (rāga):
three-eyed, with the color of lotus red,
faces of red, black, and white,
with wide-open mouth and broad chest,
wearing the crown of Amitābha,
the hero abides extending the left leg,
roiling the blazing multitudes.

A lotus, a sword, and a peg
he holds in his right hands.
With pride he holds a bell
and an enemy skull-staff in his left.
Abiding upon a lotus and the sun,

he gazes in all ten directions,
and having terrified the nāgas,
he abides in the western direction.

Born from the seed-syllable of one's own mantra,
the Lord Immovable of Envy (īrṣyā):
adorned with the crown of Amoghasiddhi's vajra,
with the color of a blue-green utpala petal,
faces of blue, red, and white,
with open mouth and manifold expressions,
broad-chested and three-eyed,
he is adorned with blazing light.

A variegated vajra, a wheel,
and a peg he holds in his right hands.
A threatening finger and a lasso mark his emblems,
and a bell and enemy skull-staff he holds in the left.
Abiding in the posture of extending the left leg,
pressing down upon a lotus and the sun,
he gazes in all ten directions,
and having dispelled the fears of the great obstructors,
he abides in the northern direction.

Thus, having utterly annihilated the assembled obstructors of all ten directions
and having thoroughly tamed all sentient beings,
the pure buddha-fields filled with the assembly of buddhas

Translator's Notes

- The title in Sanskrit, Krodharāja Sarvamantra Guhyatantra, identifies this as a wrathful deity tantra centered on Acalanātha (the Immovable), who is here called "the Wrathful Immovable Protector." The Tibetan version of the title is rendered faithfully alongside the Sanskrit heading, following the standard canonical format.

The line rendered "the conceptual thought of gnosis-thought" translates a deliberately paradoxical formulation. The Tibetan reads ye shes rtog pa'i rtog pa, literally "the conceptuality of wisdom-conceptuality," which likely indicates a technical tantric usage meaning the non-conceptual awareness that transcends ordinary discursive thought, framed as its own kind of "cognition." This is a genuine ambiguity worth noting.

The mantra syllables in the final section are transliterated as found; several of the phonetic sequences (such as "bolarga miyaṃ" and "pratāka kola") are non-standard Sanskrit and likely represent degraded or esoteric phonetic forms preserved in Tibetan transcription. No

normalization has been attempted.

The passage "tvapaṇa" in the body-purity chapter represents a Sanskrit phonetic sequence transliterated in Tibetan as tva ra ṇa, appearing amid a list of body parts (teeth, nails, body hair). It may be a dhāraṇī syllable or a fragmentary mantraic enumeration rather than a standard anatomical term.

- The mantra "Oṃ sarva tathāgata anuragaṇa vajra svabhāva ātmako'ham" means roughly "Oṃ — I am the very self, the vajra nature, the passionate longing of all Tathāgatas." The term "anuragaṇa" (Skt. anurāga) here has the sense of the passionate, devoted longing or union associated with tantric consort practice; the rendering "passionate longing" is contextually appropriate.

The deity "Nandakeśvarī" is a tentative rendering of "ཀླུ་མཚན་ལྷ་པོ་" (gNod mdzES rgyal po). Literally "gnod mdzEs" could mean "beautiful harm" or may be a transliteration of a Sanskrit deity name; the identification is uncertain. The passage may intend a specific wrathful deity whose Sanskrit name underlies the Tibetan.

The figure "ལྷ་མཚན་ལྷ་པོ་" (Vajra Vetālī, literally "Vajra Zombie-Woman") is a well-attested wrathful ḍākinī form; the rendering "Vajra Vetālī" follows standard convention.

- The passage ends mid-sentence at "the assembly of buddhas," as the supplied Tibetan text itself breaks off there. The translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

The term rendered "Lord Immovable of Envy" follows the pattern established in the preceding passage for the parallel figure "Lord Immovable of Attachment." Here the Tibetan ལྷ་མཚན་ལྷ་པོ་ indicates jealousy or envy, identified as one of the five poisons, and the figure is the corresponding wrathful guardian of that affliction.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.